

Chapter 36-2

//

Liang Shi stayed in a state of half-sleep and half-wakefulness all night.

At first, she had to watch whether the water in Xu Qingzhu's IV bottle was finished and prepare to change her to new medicine. Later, she had to worry about the needle coming out due to backflow of blood.

Xu Qingzhu's blood vessels were very thin and difficult to find. Even though the doctor was skilled and had inserted the needle properly, it was possible that any movement could cause the needle to slip out.

Liang Shi would only sleep for ten or so minutes before waking up again.

When the needle was removed, it was already past 2 AM. Xu Qingzhu's high fever still hadn't subsided, so Liang Shi used physical cooling methods to bring down her temperature.

She didn't know how many towels she had changed throughout the night. By dawn, the fever had finally broken.

In the distant sky, a pale light appeared on the horizon. The sun rose between the mountains, casting orange-red light on the skyline, and the entire city began to wake up.

Liang Shi took Xu Qingzhu's temperature and only then felt relieved enough to sleep.

However, sleeping in a chair was never comfortable, and there were only three hours left before work. She would also need to get up early to cook.

She simply rested like that for a while. Before 8 o'clock, Liang Shi's biological clock woke her up punctually.

Liang Shi looked at her watch: 7:58.

Making elaborate meals at home was impossible now; she could only make simple rice porridge and a sandwich.

She yawned sleepily, squeezing physiological tears from the corners of her eyes. She hadn't stayed up late in so long that her body felt drained. She stood up to stretch, but just as she raised her arms, she saw Xu Qingzhu slowly awakening, looking at her with those deep, unfathomable eyes that seemed to say—are you mentally ill?

Liang Shi: "..."

She awkwardly lowered her arms, "You're awake?"

Xu Qingzhu wasn't feverish to the point of stupidity and still remembered last night's events. She first raised her hand to touch her forehead, her voice still clear and cold, but hoarse from the night of high fever: "How high was my fever last night?"

"Thirty-nine degrees," Liang Shi said. "But it broke in the second half of the night."

Xu Qingzhu took a deep breath, feeling her body still had no strength, and lay back down on the bed, "Thank you."

Liang Shi said, "It's nothing."

After saying this, she paused and tentatively discussed with her: "How about you don't go to work today and work from home instead?"

Xu Qingzhu frowned, "Hmm?"

It was just a light trailing tone, but it expressed her confusion clearly.

"If that won't work, I'll also take leave and stay home to take care of you," Liang Shi said. "The doctor said this was caused by overwork. If you keep pushing yourself like this, your body will collapse before the new product launch event."

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, "No need, thank you."

Her tone was cold and distant.

Liang Shi was helpless, "What's wrong?"

"I have meetings today," Xu Qingzhu said while pressing her temples and lifting the covers to get out of bed.

She hadn't changed out of last night's clothes and had slept through the night with traces of illness. She took a deep breath and forced herself to stand up, "I appreciate your kind intentions, but I still need to go to the company."

Liang Shi: "..."

Really, no wonder you could take the company public.

But Liang Shi really couldn't bear to watch her drag her sick body to the company.

In the end, they reached a compromise: "I'll go make breakfast now. You wash up and then rest a bit. I'll drive you to the company later. You can take your medicine on the way, and I'll bring today's medicine for you. Remember to eat on time."

After saying this, she sighed again, "Forget it, I'll come to your company at noon to have lunch with you, and I'll pick you up from work in the evening."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She had already walked to the bathroom door when she suddenly turned back to look at Liang Shi: "Don't you have to work?"

Afraid that she would refuse again, Liang Shi immediately put on a slightly impatient expression, but her words were full of concern: "You're in this condition, what work am I supposed to do?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

Her expression was somewhat speechless.

But Liang Shi didn't look at her anymore and headed straight out the door.

The moment she closed the door, that strange mechanical voice rang in her mind: [Ding dong! Congratulations to the host for accumulating over forty happiness points. Current happiness point balance is forty-two, misfortune point balance is six, account balance is 37,625 yuan. You're awesome! Hope the host will continue working hard and achieve even greater success!]

Whether it was Liang Shi's imagination or not, this time the system's voice carried inexplicable excitement, rather like a "mother whose eldest daughter has finally made something of herself" tone.

[Ding dong dong! Accumulating forty happiness points triggers a passive task: Make handicrafts with Xu Qingzhu once.

Upon completion of this task, all current misfortune points will be cleared, and you'll be rewarded 49,999 yuan.

If the task is overdue/failed, misfortune points +2, triggering a first-level misfortune penalty again, including but not limited to physical injury.

If you want to abandon the task early, you can notify us one day in advance, deducting 2 happiness points with no other effects. Please work hard to complete the task!

PS: Handicrafts and ceramics are both acceptable.

PS again: Making handicrafts can bring two people closer, for example, some intimate contact, holding hands, hugging, and if the host is capable, even some kissing.

PS again again: The host next door has already taken the opportunity of making handicrafts to smooch smooch smooch! Please step up your game, host.]

What's "kissing"?

And what's "smooch smooch smooch"?

These were all blind spots in Liang Shi's knowledge.

The system even provided her with explanations in a sly voice: [Oh my! Kissing means kissing, and smooch smooch smooch means... eek... eek... it means drinking milk! Host, you're so silly. No wonder you can't catch up with the progress next door!

PS again again again: If the host can increase happiness points to sixty through passive tasks, the system will give an additional five happiness points as a gift.]

Liang Shi: "..."

Was it her imagination?

Why was this system becoming more and more lewd?

Liang Shi didn't understand and didn't want to understand.

However, the system also asked: [Host, do you want to abandon the passive task?]

Liang Shi answered without hesitation: "No."

System: [Alright, the task deadline is this Sunday evening, duration six days. PS: If you can't even complete this, you might as well just die.]

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi cursed the system eight hundred times in her mind.

The inexplicably coquettish system: [Don't secretly badmouth little system! Little system can hear everything! It's just that little system has updated the program algorithm to better meet the host's needs, so it uses this method to answer the host's questions.]

Liang Shi: "..."

She said coldly: "I'm cursing you openly."

System: [Wuwuwu, little system will be sad.]

Liang Shi: "Shut up! Get lost!"

System: [...]

The system instantly returned to seriousness, once again becoming that strange mechanical voice: [Host, keep it up. Little system will take its leave first.]

Liang Shi: "..."

After the system left, Liang Shi began to digest what it had said.

Why had happiness points suddenly accumulated so much? Was it because she had taken care of Xu Qingzhu all night?

Then if Xu Qingzhu got sick in the future and she took care of her every time...

Liang Shi felt this approach might not be sustainable.

She really wanted to find the pattern for accumulating happiness points. Last time happiness points accumulated to 20 was after Xu Qingya came to her house, she made dinner that evening, and lived under the same roof as Xu Qingzhu.

Suddenly she was told that happiness points had been successfully accumulated.

That strange mechanical voice rang out: [Host, the system advises you not to waste your efforts. There's no pattern to happiness point accumulation. Everything is based on emotional accumulation. Your target is the measuring stick for happiness points, so wouldn't it be better to put this energy into pursuing Xu Qingzhu? PS: Those who keep trying to study patterns will ultimately be defeated by patterns.]

The returning system disrupted Liang Shi's thoughts.

However, it also provided Liang Shi with important information: happiness point accumulation depended on Xu Qingzhu's favorability toward her.

There were no specific standards.

Tsk.

Liang Shi decided that filling her stomach was more important.